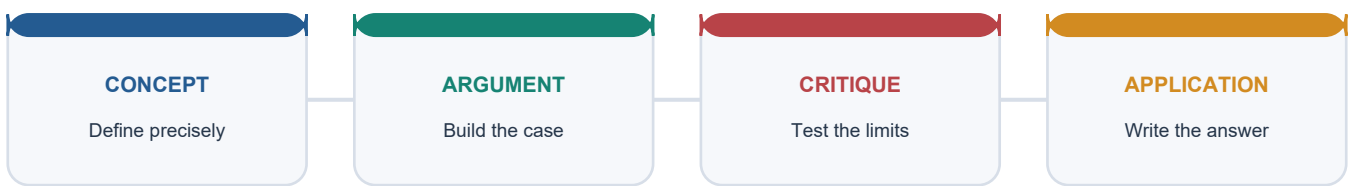


## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Jainism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section B | 32 diagnostics, 10 solved PYQs and 6 original Mains models

### LEARNING PATH



*Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.*

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Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

# CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

|                                                                                              |           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Jainism - Solved Practice Workbook</b> . . . . .                                          | <b>3</b>  |
| <b>BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION</b> . . . . .                                                    | <b>3</b>  |
| 32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills . . . . .       | 3         |
| <b>PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE</b> . . . . .                                                    | <b>19</b> |
| Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below . . . . . | 19        |

# Jainism - Solved Practice Workbook

**How to use this workbook.** Attempt every item before reading its key. The correct option position was fixed independently for each question, so no rotation or predictable sequence can be exploited. Every option carries a question-specific explanation and every question carries a unique examiner trap. The solved previous-year questions reproduce the official printed wording exactly; the model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys.

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### 32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

**Answer placement:** each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

#### CORE DIAGNOSTICS - 24 ITEMS

##### MCQ 1. The systematic anchor of Jaina philosophy

With reference to the *Tattvārthasūtra*, consider the following statements.

1. It is ascribed to Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and to Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage.
2. Its authority is confined to one of the two major traditions, which is why sectarian canons differ.
3. It states the path to liberation through right vision, right knowledge and right conduct together.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: B.**

##### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it retains statement 2, which confines the text to a single tradition, whereas the *Tattvārthasūtra* is precisely the rare work treated as authoritative across both.
- **B:** Correct: the double ascription and the joint three-jewel path formula are both standard, and together they explain why the text functions as a shared systematic grammar.
- **C:** Incorrect: it drops the double ascription that names the text's cross-sectarian standing while keeping the false restriction of its authority.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 3 are sound, but including 2 contradicts them by denying the very cross-sectarian acceptance that makes the text quotable for both traditions.

**Examiner trap 1:** Shared textual authority is not doctrinal uniformity; the same *sūtra* text can anchor both traditions while canon, monastic practice and several details continue to diverge.

### MCQ 2. What the title-words of the tradition actually mean

In Jaina usage, the terms *jina* and *tirthaṅkara* respectively designate

- A. one who has conquered the passions and karmic bondage, and a liberated teacher who re-establishes the crossing over rebirth
- B. the creator of the ordered cosmos, and the divine agent who allots merit and demerit to embodied beings at each rebirth
- C. the first teacher of the present cycle alone, and any monk who has completed the five great vows under supervision
- D. a soul that has suppressed delusion temporarily, and a householder who has taken the lesser vows before ordination

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: *jina* is the conqueror of passions from whom the tradition takes its name, and a *tirthaṅkara* is the ford-maker who rebuilds the crossing over the cycle of rebirth.
- **B:** Incorrect: it smuggles creation and divine allotment into a system that explains inequality by action-matter and denies a creator altogether.
- **C:** Incorrect: it confuses a title of spiritual achievement with a chronological rank and with ordinary monastic completion of the vows.
- **D:** Incorrect: temporary suppression of delusion belongs to the eleventh stage, and lesser vows belong to householders; neither term is defined that way.

**Examiner trap 2:** Reverence for perfected teachers is not theism; Jainism honours achieved perfection while denying that any being made or governs the world.

### MCQ 3. The definition of the real

In the Jaina formula *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya-yuktaṃ sat*, the real is characterised by

- A. persistence alone, since change belongs only to appearance and never to the substance itself
- B. origination alone, since a thing is nothing more than the series of its successive productions
- C. origination, decay and persistence taken together, in one and the same real
- D. decay alone, since every determinate thing is defined by the moment at which it ceases

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: reducing change to appearance is the static-monist error that Jainism explicitly rejects, since it cannot explain why the bracelet actually became a ring.
- **B:** Incorrect: a pure series of productions is closer to momentariness and leaves recognition of the same gold across the change unexplained.
- **C:** Correct: the real is defined by origination, decay and persistence together, which is what allows permanence to be predicated of substance and change of mode.
- **D:** Incorrect: making cessation definitional inverts the doctrine, because persistence is precisely the term that blocks a purely momentary reading.

**Examiner trap 3:** The three terms are joint, not alternative; a script that offers "permanence with some change" has already lost the definition, because change is constitutive rather than conceded.

#### MCQ 4. Substance, quality and mode

Which statement correctly states the relation among substance (*dravya*), quality (*guṇa*) and mode (*pariyāya*)?

- A. Quality is the abiding characteristic of a persisting substance, while mode is the changing state in which it appears
- B. Quality and mode are two names for the same changing state, distinguished only by the standpoint of the observer
- C. Substance is an inference from modes alone, since qualities are conventional descriptions with no bearer
- D. Mode is the abiding characteristic of a substance, while quality is the momentary state it currently exhibits

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics, whereas modes are its changing states, which is why consciousness is a quality of the soul while delusion is a mode.
- **B:** Incorrect: collapsing the two removes the distinction that lets Jainism assert permanence and change of one thing in different respects.
- **C:** Incorrect: treating the substance as a mere inference concedes the Buddhist nominalist case that Jainism answers by insisting that changes require something whose changes they are.
- **D:** Incorrect: it exactly reverses the two terms, which is the most frequent examinable confusion in this part of the syllabus.

**Examiner trap 4:** Consciousness is a *guṇa* of the soul; pleasure, pain, delusion and liberated omniscience are *pariyāyas* - the same soul, different states.

#### MCQ 5. Substances and extended substances

Which one of the following is a real substance (*dravya*) in mainstream Jaina exposition but **not** an extended substance (*astikāya*)?

- A. Space (*ākāśa*)
- B. Time (*kāla*)
- C. Matter (*pudgala*)
- D. Medium of rest (*adharma*)

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: space is an extended substance, articulated as world-space and the space beyond the world, and it accommodates the other substances.
- **B:** Correct: time is admitted as a substance but is not an extended substance, which is why the tradition speaks of five extended substances plus time.
- **C:** Incorrect: matter is extended and aggregative, and it is additionally the only substance that possesses form.
- **D:** Incorrect: the medium of rest is an extended substance co-extensive with world-space, on a par with the medium of motion.

**Examiner trap 5:** Six substances but five extended substances; writing "six *astikāyas*" converts a precise doctrine into an avoidable factual error.

### MCQ 6. Two substances with misleading names

In Jaina ontology, *dharma-dravya* and *adharma-dravya* respectively signify

- A. accumulated merit and accumulated demerit, which jointly determine the quality of the next embodiment
- B. right conduct and wrong conduct, understood as the two moral orientations available to an embodied soul
- C. the medium that makes motion possible and the medium that makes rest possible for souls and matter
- D. the ordering principle of the cosmos and the disordering principle that produces decay within it

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: merit and demerit are *puṇya* and *pāpa*, which appear in the ninefold list of categories, not in the sixfold list of substances.
- **B:** Incorrect: conduct is treated under right conduct and the vows; the substances in question are cosmological conditions, not moral orientations.
- **C:** Correct: they are enabling conditions of movement and rest, comparable to water for a swimming fish, and they are co-extensive with world-space.
- **D:** Incorrect: no Jaina text assigns them cosmic order and disorder; they enable motion and rest without themselves pushing or halting anything.

**Examiner trap 6:** The same two Sanskrit words carry a moral sense elsewhere in Indian philosophy; in Jaina ontology they are strictly media, and the shift of sense is deliberately examined.

### MCQ 7. The Jaina conception of the soul

Which statement best expresses the Jaina conception of the soul (*jīva*)?

- A. It is one universal consciousness that appears as many only through the beginningless operation of ignorance
- B. It is one of innumerable distinct substances, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power
- C. It is a stream of momentary cognitions with no bearer, so that personal identity is a useful conventional fiction
- D. It is an eternal substance that becomes conscious only when the internal organ is conjoined with it in embodiment

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Advaita position; Jainism holds that souls are numerically many and remain distinct even after liberation.
- **B:** Correct: souls are innumerable, beginningless and intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad, which is obscured rather than absent in bondage.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the Buddhist no-self account, which Jainism rejects because bondage and liberation require an enduring knower.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya account of a self that knows through conjunction with the internal organ; in Jainism consciousness is intrinsic.

**Examiner trap 7:** Intrinsic omniscience is not empirical omniscience; the soul's infinite knowledge is present as capacity and obscured in fact, which is exactly what action-matter is introduced to explain.

### MCQ 8. What is distinctive about matter

Which feature uniquely marks matter (*pudgala*) among the six substances?

- A. It alone is co-extensive with world-space and therefore accommodates every other substance within it
- B. It alone lacks space-points, which is why it can be divided indefinitely without any residue remaining
- C. It alone undergoes origination and decay, the remaining substances being exempt from modal change
- D. It alone possesses form, that is colour, taste, smell and touch, and is therefore sense-perceptible

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: accommodation is the function of space; matter occupies room rather than providing it.
- **B:** Incorrect: matter is extended and aggregative, built from indivisible atoms combining into aggregates, so indefinite division without residue is not the Jaina view.
- **C:** Incorrect: every substance has modes; origination and decay belong to the definition of the real as such, not to matter alone.
- **D:** Correct: matter is the sole substance with form, which is why sound is classed as a material modification and why karmic matter can adhere at all.

**Examiner trap 8:** In Jainism sound is a modification of matter, not a quality of ether; importing the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treatment of sound here is a silent cross-school error.

### MCQ 9. Ordinary perception in the strict Jaina classification

In the strict Jaina epistemological classification, ordinary sensory cognition is

- A. direct knowledge in the fullest sense, since sense-contact provides the clearest access available to an embodied knower
- B. invalid cognition, because the senses are themselves products of karmic matter and therefore systematically deceive
- C. only conventional direct knowledge, and strictly belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense and mind
- D. a species of scriptural knowledge, since every perceptual judgement is already structured by inherited verbal categories

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya expectation; Jainism measures directness by absence of mediation, not by sensory clarity.
- **B:** Incorrect: ordinary perception is valid for practical dealings, and its wrongness arises only under wrong orientation, not from the senses as such.
- **C:** Correct: ordinary perception is *sāṃvyaṭahārika pratyakṣa*, direct for practical purposes but mediated by organ, mind and karmic limitation.
- **D:** Incorrect: verbal knowledge is derived from sense-and-mind cognition rather than constituting it, so the dependence runs the other way.

**Examiner trap 9:** The Jaina and Nyāya senses of *pratyakṣa* differ; using the word without the qualifier "conventional" imports a rival classification into a Jaina answer.

### MCQ 10. Classifying the five kinds of knowledge

Which pair is correctly classified as indirect (*parokṣa*) in the basic fivefold scheme of knowledge?

- A. Clairvoyant knowledge and knowledge of others' mental modes
- B. Knowledge of others' mental modes and omniscience
- C. Sense-and-mind cognition and clairvoyant knowledge
- D. Sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: both members are strictly direct, since the soul knows without the mediation of sense or mind, even though both remain limited.
- **B:** Incorrect: both are direct, and omniscience is the complete case of directness rather than an instance of mediation.
- **C:** Incorrect: it pairs one genuinely mediated kind with one strictly direct kind, so the classification is half right and therefore wrong.
- **D:** Correct: sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge are mediated, the second being derived from the first through signs and teaching.

**Examiner trap 10:** Verbal or scriptural knowledge is not blind faith; it is a mediated cognition dependent on prior cognition and communication, and Jainism grades it accordingly.

### MCQ 11. The order of the five kinds of knowledge

Which sequence correctly states the five kinds of Jaina knowledge in ascending order?

- A. Śruta, mati, avadhi, kevala, manañparyāya
- B. Mati, avadhi, śruta, manañparyāya, kevala
- C. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manañparyāya, kevala
- D. Avadhi, manañparyāya, mati, śruta, kevala

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it inverts the first pair and places omniscience before knowledge of others' mental modes, breaking the graded removal of obscuration.
- **B:** Incorrect: it inserts clairvoyance between the two mediated kinds, separating verbal knowledge from the sense-and-mind cognition it derives from.
- **C:** Correct: the canonical ascending order runs sense-and-mind cognition, verbal knowledge, clairvoyance, knowledge of others' mental modes, and omniscience.
- **D:** Incorrect: it places the two direct but limited kinds before the mediated kinds, reversing the logic of progressive unveiling.

**Examiner trap 11:** The order is not a ranking of usefulness but a curve of karmic unveiling; each step marks how much knowledge-obscuring action-matter has been removed.



### MCQ 12. Jaina causation

The Jaina account of causation is best described as

- A. both-existence-and-non-existence of the effect, since the effect pre-exists as substance and is new as mode
- B. pre-existence of the effect without qualification, since nothing genuinely new can ever be produced
- C. fresh production of the effect without qualification, since the effect is entirely absent before its production
- D. dependent origination without any substrate, since causal regularity is all that causal talk records

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the effect is continuous with the cause as enduring substance and novel as fresh mode, which is many-sidedness applied to causal identity.
- **B:** Incorrect: unqualified pre-existence is the Sāṃkhya position, and it makes production add nothing at all.
- **C:** Incorrect: unqualified fresh production is the Nyāya position, and it leaves unexplained why clay yields a jar rather than anything whatever.
- **D:** Incorrect: dependence without a substrate is the Buddhist framing, which Jainism rejects because it dissolves the persisting bearer of change.

**Examiner trap 12:** Calling Jaina causation *satkāryavāda* is a common slip; the whole point of the Jaina label is the added respect-index that Sāṃkhya does not use.

### MCQ 13. What many-sidedness asserts

The doctrine of many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*) primarily asserts that

- A. all judgements are equally true, since standpoints cannot be ranked and disagreement is therefore merely apparent
- B. reality is unknowable in itself, so that every description reports only the classificatory habits of the describer
- C. contradictory properties genuinely belong to one thing at one time and in one and the same respect
- D. the real object possesses innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: equal truth for all judgements is relativism, whereas Jainism grades judgements by whether they respect their own conditions.
- **B:** Incorrect: unknowability contradicts Jaina realism, which holds that aspects are objectively in the thing and are genuinely reached under standpoints.
- **C:** Incorrect: identity of respect is exactly what the *syāt* operator excludes; without different indices there would be a plain contradiction.
- **D:** Correct: the thesis is that the real is *ananta-dharmātmakam vastu*, so finite judgement necessarily captures an aspect rather than the whole.

**Examiner trap 13:** Many-sidedness is ontology before it is logic; a script that introduces it as tolerance or open-mindedness has lost the derivation that the doctrine of judgement depends on.

#### MCQ 14. Three doctrines, three levels

Which formulation correctly distinguishes the three doctrines?

- A. Many-sidedness is metaphysical, standpoint theory is epistemic, and conditional predication is the logical-linguistic form of assertion
- B. Many-sidedness is logical, standpoint theory is ethical, and conditional predication is the metaphysical basis of the other two
- C. Many-sidedness and conditional predication are identical, while standpoint theory is a later scholastic elaboration of both
- D. Standpoint theory is metaphysical, conditional predication is epistemic, and many-sidedness is a rule of monastic debate

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the three occupy distinct levels, and the sevenfold predication is the formal schema in which the third operates.
- **B:** Incorrect: it misassigns every level and turns standpoint theory into ethics, which no Jaina exposition supports.
- **C:** Incorrect: identifying the metaphysical thesis with the mode of assertion destroys the derivation from object to knower to sentence.
- **D:** Incorrect: reducing many-sidedness to a debating convention removes the ontological claim on which the whole system rests.

**Examiner trap 14:** The examiner is testing levels, not vocabulary; naming all three terms without assigning each its level scores as recall rather than understanding.

#### MCQ 15. The first of the seven standpoints

Which one of the following is the first member of the classical list of seven standpoints (*naya*)?

- A. *Samgraha naya*, the generic standpoint attending to shared class-character
- B. *R̥jusūtra naya*, the standpoint restricted to the thing in its present state
- C. *Naigama naya*, the mixed practical or purposive standpoint
- D. *Evambhūta naya*, the standpoint on which a term applies only during actual function

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the generic standpoint is second, and it narrows what the first standpoint leaves deliberately mixed.
- **B:** Incorrect: the present-state standpoint is fourth and forms the hinge between substance-directed and mode-directed views.
- **C:** Correct: the mixed practical or purposive standpoint opens the list, blending general and particular, often through intention.
- **D:** Incorrect: the function-in-act standpoint is seventh and the strictest, so placing it first inverts the entire funnel.

**Examiner trap 15:** The list moves from loosest to strictest; reciting it out of order destroys the analytical point that partiality tightens as language becomes more literal.

### MCQ 16. Matching a standpoint with its emphasis

Which pairing of a standpoint with its characteristic emphasis is correct?

- A. *Vyavahāra naya* - the etymological differentiation of synonymous words
- B. *Śabda naya* - the class-character shared by every member of a kind
- C. *Samgraha naya* - the thing considered strictly as it is at the present moment
- D. *Evambhūta naya* - the term applies only while the named function is being performed

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: etymological differentiation belongs to *samabhirūḍha*, while the practical standpoint concerns ordinary dealings with particulars.
- **B:** Incorrect: class-character belongs to the generic standpoint, while the verbal standpoint attends to the expression actually used.
- **C:** Incorrect: the present-moment restriction belongs to *ṛjusūtra*; the generic standpoint deliberately abstracts from present particularity.
- **D:** Correct: on the function-in-act standpoint a person counts as a singer only while singing is actually occurring.

**Examiner trap 16:** The last three standpoints are all verbal, so they are easily swapped; distinguish attention to the word, to its derivation, and to the performance it names.

### MCQ 17. What the particle *syāt* contributes

In the doctrine of conditional predication, the particle *syāt* is best rendered as

- A. "probably", marking that the assertion is likely but not certain on the evidence available to the speaker
- B. "in a certain respect", marking a definite assertion restricted by substance, place, time and mode
- C. "apparently", marking that the assertion holds for appearances although the thing in itself is unknown
- D. "let it be granted", marking a provisional concession made only for the purposes of a formal debate

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: probability is precisely the reading Jaina authors reject, since the assertion is definite and only its respect is restricted.
- **B:** Correct: the operator states the respect in which the predication holds, which is why it blocks absolutisation without weakening assertion.
- **C:** Incorrect: an appearance-reality split is alien to Jaina realism, in which aspects are objectively in the thing.
- **D:** Incorrect: a debating concession is temporary and strategic, whereas the operator is a permanent feature of correct assertion.

**Examiner trap 17:** "The jar conditionally exists" is not a guess that the jar probably exists; treating *syāt* as a hedge converts a realist doctrine into scepticism.

### MCQ 18. The fourth of the seven predications

In the sevenfold predication (*saptabhaṅgī*), the fourth member is

- A. *syād asti ca nāsti ca*, in some respect it is and it is not
- B. *syān nāsti*, in some respect it is not
- C. *syād asti ca avaktavyam*, in some respect it is and is inexpressible
- D. *syād avaktavyam*, in some respect it is inexpressible

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the successive conjunction of affirmation and negation is the third member, not the fourth.
- **B:** Incorrect: simple negation is the second member and is one of the three primitives from which the rest are built.
- **C:** Incorrect: the combination of affirmation with inexpressibility is the fifth member, which presupposes the fourth already stated.
- **D:** Correct: inexpressibility is the third primitive and stands as the fourth member, arising when affirmation and negation are demanded simultaneously and unqualifiedly.

**Examiner trap 18:** Three primitives taken singly, in pairs and jointly give three plus three plus one; misplacing inexpressibility breaks the combinatorial derivation that explains why there are exactly seven.

### MCQ 19. The meaning of inexpressibility

In the sevenfold predication, *avaktavya* chiefly signifies that

- A. a single unqualified expression cannot convey affirmation and negation simultaneously
- B. the object in question lies wholly beyond language and can be approached only in silence
- C. the speaker suspends judgement because the available evidence is insufficient for assertion
- D. the proposition takes a third truth-value lying between plain truth and plain falsity

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: inexpressibility records a limit of simultaneous unqualified expression, not a limit of reality or of the speaker's evidence.
- **B:** Incorrect: mystical ineffability is not the Jaina claim, since the same object is expressible under each separate index.
- **C:** Incorrect: suspension of judgement is scepticism, whereas each of the seven forms is an assertion under a stated condition.
- **D:** Incorrect: a third truth-value would make the operator a semantic value rather than a standpoint index, which Jaina authors do not claim.

**Examiner trap 19:** Inexpressibility is a fact about one utterance, not about the thing; the same jar is perfectly expressible once the respect is separated out.

### MCQ 20. Why no contradiction arises

The Jaina claim that "in some respect the jar is and is not" escapes formal contradiction because

- A. affirmation is literal while negation is figurative, so the two predicates never occupy the same logical plane
- B. the law of non-contradiction is denied outright, and Jaina logic replaces it with a rule of graded assertion
- C. one of the two predications is always merely conventional and is finally cancelled by the other
- D. affirmation and negation are indexed to different substance, place, time or mode, so the respects differ

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no Jaina text makes negation figurative; both predications are literal and both are true under their own index.
- **B:** Incorrect: the doctrine preserves non-contradiction rather than abandoning it, which is precisely how it answers Śaṃkara.
- **C:** Incorrect: cancellation of one level by another is the Advaita structure of sublation, which Jaina aspect-realism does not employ.
- **D:** Correct: contradiction requires the same respect, time and sense, and the four indices guarantee that this identity never obtains.

**Examiner trap 20:** Without naming substance, place, time and mode the reply to the contradiction charge is an assertion rather than an argument, and examiners mark exactly that difference.

### MCQ 21. The self-refutation objection

The standard self-refutation objection against many-sidedness argues that

- A. the doctrine cannot explain how a single soul is reborn while remaining numerically the same individual
- B. if every assertion must be qualified then the doctrine itself must be qualified, and it then loses universal force
- C. the doctrine presupposes a creator who guarantees that the many aspects of a thing form a coherent whole
- D. the seven predications are too few, since the number of aspects in a real thing is admittedly innumerable

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: personal identity across rebirth is answered by the enduring substance, and it is not what the self-refutation charge targets.
- **B:** Correct: the dilemma is that qualification appears to weaken the thesis while non-qualification appears to violate its own rule.
- **C:** Incorrect: no critic derives a creator from many-sidedness, and Jainism denies a creator on independent grounds.
- **D:** Incorrect: the number seven is derived combinatorially from three primitives and does not claim to enumerate aspects.

**Examiner trap 21:** The Jaina reply accepts the first horn rather than escaping the dilemma: the thesis is itself asserted conditionally, and that obedience is offered as evidence of consistency.

### MCQ 22. The 2022 absolutism charge

Which is the strongest Jaina reply to the claim that non-absolutism cannot be sustained without postulating absolutism?

- A. Non-absolutism denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers, while omniscience remains the internal case of complete knowledge
- B. Non-absolutism is a purely practical maxim of debate and therefore makes no claim about reality that could be absolute
- C. Non-absolutism is asserted absolutely, and the resulting exception is accepted as the necessary cost of any general theory
- D. Non-absolutism concerns only religious language, so the objection misapplies a logical test to a devotional context

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the charge equivocates between denying exclusivism and denying comprehensiveness, and separating them dissolves the alleged contradiction.
- **B:** Incorrect: reducing the doctrine to a debating maxim abandons its ontological content and concedes the triviality charge instead.
- **C:** Incorrect: claiming an open exception is exactly what the objection alleges and would confirm rather than answer it.
- **D:** Incorrect: many-sidedness is asserted of reality generally, so restricting it to religious language misdescribes the doctrine.

**Examiner trap 22:** The reply does not eliminate the unconditioned; it relocates it to omniscience, and a critical answer should record that residue rather than declare a clean victory.

### MCQ 23. What is distinctive about Jaina action-matter

Which statement best captures the Jaina conception of action and moral consequence (*karma*)?

- A. It is an unseen quality residing in the self that produces its result at the appointed time without material mediation
- B. It is subtle matter that flows toward the soul and adheres to it, with passion determining the depth and duration of that adhesion
- C. It is a mental impression left by volition, so that continuity of character is secured without any enduring bearer
- D. It is an unseen potency generated by ritual action alone, which links the act performed to the result eventually enjoyed

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: an unseen quality of the self is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika *adṛṣṭa*, which Jainism replaces with genuinely material particles.
- **B:** Correct: action-matter is a form of matter, and the pairing of activity with passion fixes what is bound and for how long.
- **C:** Incorrect: a mental impression without a bearer is the Buddhist *vāsanā*, which cannot supply Jaina material bondage.
- **D:** Incorrect: a ritual potency is the Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, and it is neither material nor tied to the passions in the Jaina manner.

**Examiner trap 23:** Writing "karma" without "material" loses the single thesis that makes the Jaina account distinctive among Indian theories of moral consequence.

#### MCQ 24. Two forms of bondage

Which pair correctly distinguishes the two forms of bondage recognised by the Jainas?

- A. Psychic bondage is the soul's own passionate modification, while material bondage is the actual adhesion of karmic particles
- B. Psychic bondage is bondage to mental objects, while material bondage is bondage to physical objects such as wealth and body
- C. Psychic bondage occurs in ascetics who retain subtle pride, while material bondage occurs only in householders
- D. Psychic bondage is the intention behind an act, while material bondage is the external act as observed by others

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: *bhāvabandha* is a modification of the soul and *dravyabandha* is the material adhesion it attracts, and the two are distinct yet interlinked.
- **B:** Incorrect: the distinction is not between kinds of object but between the soul's state and the matter that adheres to it.
- **C:** Incorrect: both forms operate for any bound soul; the ascetic-householder difference concerns the scope of vows, not the kinds of bondage.
- **D:** Incorrect: reducing the pair to intention and outward act loses the ontological claim that karmic matter really adheres.

**Examiner trap 24:** Collapsing the two forms costs either the moral psychology or the ontology; the 2024 paper asks for the distinction precisely because it carries both.

#### REMEDIAL DRILLS - 8 ERROR-TARGETING ITEMS

#### MCQ 25. The five causes of bondage

Which set correctly gives the five causes of bondage recognised in Jaina soteriology?

- A. Ignorance, craving, clinging, becoming and birth
- B. Influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and liberation
- C. Wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passions and activity
- D. Anger, pride, deceit, greed and delusion

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is a Buddhist chain of dependent origination and has no place in a Jaina list of causes of bondage.
- **B:** Incorrect: these are stages of the soteriological sequence, four of which are remedies or outcomes rather than causes.
- **C:** Correct: wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passion and activity are the standard five, with passion supplying adhesion and activity the channel.
- **D:** Incorrect: anger, pride, deceit and greed are the passions, so this option expands one cause into the whole list.

**Examiner trap 25:** The passions are one member of the list, not the list itself; a script that gives four passions plus delusion has answered a different question.

### MCQ 26. What determines what in bondage

Which pairing of a bondage parameter with its principal determinant is correct?

- A. Duration is determined by activity, while type is determined by passion
- B. Intensity is determined by activity, while quantity is determined by passion
- C. Type is determined by wrong vision, while duration is determined by carelessness
- D. Type and quantity are determined by activity, while duration and intensity are determined by passion

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it reverses the division of labour, and duration is the parameter most clearly governed by the passions.
- **B:** Incorrect: it also reverses the pairing, since intensity of fruition tracks passion and quantity of matter tracks activity.
- **C:** Incorrect: wrong vision and carelessness are causes of bondage, not determinants of these four technical parameters.
- **D:** Correct: activity fixes which karma and how much, while passion fixes how long and how strongly, which is why passion-free activity binds only momentarily.

**Examiner trap 26:** This pairing is the technical basis of the contrast between momentary and durable bondage; reversing it silently destroys the Jaina ethics of intention.

### MCQ 27. Destructive and non-destructive karmas

Which set contains only destructive (*ghātiyā*) karmas?

- A. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus
- B. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, vedanīya and gotra
- C. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya and antarāya
- D. Mohanīya, antarāya, nāma and āyus

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: all four members are non-destructive, since they determine felt experience, body, status and lifespan without obscuring essential qualities.
- **B:** Incorrect: it mixes two knowledge- and perception-obscuring karmas with two that merely structure embodiment.
- **C:** Correct: these four obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation and power, which is why their destruction yields omniscience at the thirteenth stage.
- **D:** Incorrect: it pairs two genuinely destructive karmas with two that determine body and lifespan.

**Examiner trap 27:** Deluding karma is the most dangerous of the destructive group because it corrupts both right vision and right conduct; omitting it from the destructive set is a substantive error.



### MCQ 28. Seven principles and nine categories

The nine categories (*padārtha*) of Jaina exposition consist of

- A. the seven principles together with substance and mode, which supply the ontological framework
- B. the seven principles together with merit and demerit, which make moral valence explicit
- C. the six substances together with influx, bondage and liberation, which complete the cosmology
- D. the seven principles together with right knowledge and right conduct, which complete the path

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: substance and mode belong to the general theory of the real and are not added to the sevenfold list.
- **B:** Correct: merit and demerit are added to the seven principles, and they can also be subsumed under influx and bondage.
- **C:** Incorrect: the six substances are a different enumeration and are not combined with three members of the sevenfold list.
- **D:** Incorrect: right knowledge and right conduct belong to the three jewels and are not counted among the categories.

**Examiner trap 28:** Merit is still bondage; treating it as a stage on the way to liberation confuses a better rebirth with release from rebirth altogether.

### MCQ 29. Stoppage and shedding

Which statement correctly distinguishes stoppage (*saṃvara*) and shedding (*nirjarā*)?

- A. Stoppage removes karma already bound, while shedding prevents new karma from being bound at all
- B. Stoppage belongs to householders and shedding to ascetics, the two being stages of a single vow
- C. Stoppage and shedding are alternative names for the same disciplinary process, differing only by tradition
- D. Stoppage blocks fresh influx of karmic matter, while shedding wears away karma already accumulated

**Answer: D.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it exactly reverses the two functions, which is the most frequent error in answers on the soteriological sequence.
- **B:** Incorrect: both operate at every level of practice, and neither is restricted by monastic status.
- **C:** Incorrect: the sequence lists them as distinct stages precisely because bondage has two independent problems, arrival and accumulation.
- **D:** Correct: stoppage is preventive and shedding is eliminative, which is why vows and austerity are both required for liberation.

**Examiner trap 29:** Austerity accelerates shedding but does not replace stoppage; sweeping a room whose door stands open is the image the tradition itself invites.

### MCQ 30. The eleventh stage of spiritual development

With reference to the fourteen stages, which statement is correct?

- A. The eleventh stage destroys delusion permanently and therefore leads directly to the twelfth and thirteenth stages
- B. The eleventh stage only suppresses delusion, so a soul reaching it by that ladder necessarily falls back
- C. The eleventh stage marks the attainment of right vision for the first time and is the decisive breakthrough
- D. The eleventh stage is the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state

**Answer: B.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: destruction of delusion is the twelfth stage, reached by the ladder of annihilation rather than by suppression.
- **B:** Correct: suppressed delusion is covered rather than destroyed, so the ladder of suppression cannot hold the eleventh stage.
- **C:** Incorrect: the first stable attainment of right vision is the fourth stage, which is the decisive breakthrough of the ascent.
- **D:** Incorrect: the momentary activity-free condition is the fourteenth stage, immediately before the perfected state.

**Examiner trap 30:** Suppression and destruction look identical from outside and have opposite futures; the two ladders exist to explain spiritual relapse without treating it as failure of insight.

### MCQ 31. Omniscience while embodied

The condition described as *sayoga-kevali* is best characterised as

- A. a soul that has suppressed all passions and awaits the fruition of its deluding karma before liberation
- B. a householder who has taken the lesser vows and attained limited clairvoyant knowledge of material things
- C. an omniscient being still embodied and active, whose destructive karmas are destroyed while non-destructive karmas remain
- D. a perfected soul at the summit of the world, disembodied and free from every trace of karmic matter

**Answer: C.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: mere suppression belongs to the eleventh stage and is incompatible with the omniscience that defines this condition.
- **B:** Incorrect: lesser vows and clairvoyance belong far lower on the ladder and involve no destruction of the obscuring karmas.
- **C:** Correct: destruction of the destructive karmas yields omniscience, while the remaining non-destructive karmas sustain embodiment and activity.
- **D:** Incorrect: the disembodied perfected soul is the *siddha*, which follows only after the fourteenth stage.

**Examiner trap 31:** This is the Jaina form of liberation-in-life; denying that omniscience can coexist with embodiment misreads the destructive and non-destructive division of karmas.

### MCQ 32. Voluntary passionless death

Which statement about *sallekhanā* is doctrinally the safest to write in an examination?

- A. It is a gradual, supervised and passion-free relinquishment of food undertaken when death is already unavoidable or decline incurable
- B. It is a meritorious act of self-destruction that may be undertaken by any practitioner who wishes to shorten a difficult life
- C. It has been conclusively settled in Indian law as a protected religious practice, so its legal status raises no further question
- D. It is identical with suicide in every philosophically relevant respect, differing only in the vocabulary used to describe it

**Answer: A.**

#### Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the vow requires equanimity, supervision, gradualness and the absence of any desire for death or for continued life.
- **B:** Incorrect: a wish to shorten life is itself a passion and converts the observance into a transgression of the vow's own discipline.
- **C:** Incorrect: legal holdings must not be asserted without verification, and an examination answer should report the controversy rather than settle it.
- **D:** Incorrect: suicide is sudden, passion-driven and often concealed, whereas the vow is gradual, passionless, non-violent and public.

**Examiner trap 32:** The doctrinal test is the inner state, not the outward abstention; if desire for death, attachment or hope of reward enters, the act becomes a transgression rather than a fulfilment of the vow.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

### Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

**Verified wording.** Every previous-year question below is reproduced exactly as printed in the held UPSC Civil Services (Main) Philosophy Paper I question papers, 2018-2025, with the year, question number and marks as printed. **No official key exists in the repository for these descriptive questions.** The model answers are independent learner practice written to the stated word band and directive. They are never presented as official UPSC keys, and no objective answer letter is asserted for any descriptive question. **Ownership.** Nine of the ten solved questions are primary-owned by Jainism. The tenth is primary-owned by Cārvāka and is solved here because its second half cannot be answered without the Jaina conception of reality. **Word bands used.** 10 marks: 150-200 words. 15 marks: 250-300 words. 20 marks: 340-400 words.

### VERIFIED PREVIOUS-YEAR QUESTIONS - TEN COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

**PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q6(c) · 15 marks · Jainism**

**Question, as printed:** How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.

**Demand decoded.** Three explicit demands under a "Discuss" directive: the mechanism of bondage, the contrast between two classes of soul, and the positive condition of the liberated soul. Answer all three in order; the third is the one most scripts omit.

**Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).**

Jaina bondage is a real material event, not a moral metaphor. The soul is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power, yet in embodied life these stand obscured. That obscuration requires a binding factor, and Jainism identifies it as action-matter (*karma-pudgala*), a subtle form of matter drawn to the soul.

The mechanism runs through five causes: wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passions and activity. Activity of body, speech and mind opens the channel of influx (*āsrava*) and determines the type and quantity of karma bound; passion supplies the adhesion and determines its duration and intensity. Bondage therefore has two faces: psychic bondage (*bhāvabandha*), the soul's own passionate modification, and material bondage (*dravyabandha*), the actual adhesion of karmic particles. The relation is beginningless (*anādi*) but not endless.

The bound soul (*baddha-jīva*) is thus an embodied, karmically conditioned knower whose native capacities are veiled and whose body, status, lifespan and felt experience are determined by the non-destructive karmas. The liberated soul (*mukta-jīva*) is one from which stoppage (*saṁvara*) has excluded fresh influx and shedding (*nirjarā*) has removed the accumulated deposit, so that nothing foreign remains.

On its condition, the Jainas are precise. The liberated soul is a perfected soul (*siddha*): disembodied, activity-free, beyond rebirth, and manifesting the infinite tetrad in full. Crucially it retains numerical individuality; there is no merger into a universal consciousness as in Advaita, and no dissolution as in accounts of no-self. Being unweighted by karmic matter it rises to the summit of the world (*siddha-śilā*).

The account is internally coherent, though the interaction of formless soul and subtle matter remains its contested joint.

**PYQ 2 · 2019 · Q6(a) · 20 marks · Jainism**

**Question, as printed:** How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.

**Demand decoded.** The hinge word is "reflected". The examiner wants a derivation, not two separate essays. Define reality first; then show that the theory of judgement follows from that definition rather than accompanying it.

**Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).**

The Jainas define the real (*sat*) as that which possesses origination (*utpāda*), decay (*vyaya*) and persistence (*dhrauvya*) together. The definition is chosen to save two facts that rival definitions sacrifice. Pure permanence cannot explain that a bracelet became a ring; pure flux cannot explain why this is recognised as the same gold. Indexing permanence to substance (*dravya*) and change to mode (*pariyāya*), with quality (*guṇa*) as the abiding characteristic, secures both.

From this follows many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*): the real is *ananta-dharmātmakam vastu*, a thing constituted by innumerable aspects. Its ontology is pluralist - six substances, of which five are extended, and innumerable souls - and its causation is correspondingly qualified, the effect being continuous with the cause as substance and novel as mode.

The reflection in judgement is strict rather than analogical. Ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*, arising from the partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma; it is therefore necessarily partial. A judgement by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole. That yields standpoint theory (*ṇayavāda*), and the tradition classifies seven standpoints, running from the mixed practical view through the generic, the particular and the present-state view to the three increasingly literal verbal standpoints. A standpoint that denies the remaining aspects ceases to be a standpoint and becomes its perversion (*ṇayābhāsa*), which is the technical form of one-sidedness

(*ekāntavāda*).

Because judgement is standpoint-bound, assertion must carry the operator *syāt*: conditional predication (*syādvāda*). Combining affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under that operator, taken singly, pairwise and jointly, yields exactly seven predications (*saptabhāṅgī*) - three plus three plus one. Opposed predications are indexed to substance, place, time and mode, so existence is asserted in own-form and non-existence in other-form; contradiction would require identity of respect, which the operator excludes.

Thus the theory of judgement is not an ornament on the theory of reality but its epistemic consequence: because the object exceeds any single finite judgement, and because the knower is karmically partial, unconditioned assertion is available only to omniscience (*kevala-jñāna*).

The derivation is powerful, though Śaṅkara's residual objection - that a doctrine which qualifies even itself weakens its assertoric force - is not fully removed.

**PYQ 3 · 2020 · Q5(a) · 10 marks · Jainism**

**Question, as printed:** Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?

**Demand decoded.** "Examine" asks for accurate componential analysis, and the second sentence demands the causal link. A definition without the bearing scores half.

**Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).**

For Jainism, action and moral consequence is not an unseen quality of the self, as in Nyāya *adr̥ṣṭa*, nor a ritual potency as in Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, nor a mental impression as in Buddhist *vāsanā*. It is subtle matter (*karma-pudgala*) that flows toward the soul and adheres to it. Psychical action-matter (*bhāva-karma*), the soul's passionate modification, attracts material action-matter (*dravya-karma*).

Adhesion is analysed under four parameters: activity fixes the type and quantity bound, while passion fixes the duration and intensity. Eight karma-types divide into four destructive, which obscure knowledge, perception, right orientation and power, and four non-destructive, which determine felt experience, body, status and lifespan.

The bearing on liberation (*mokṣa*) is direct. Since bondage is a real deposit, liberation is subtraction and not acquisition: stoppage (*saṃvara*) closes the channel and shedding (*nirjarā*) removes the accumulation. Destroying the destructive karmas yields omniscience while still embodied; exhausting the non-destructive karmas yields the perfected soul.

Liberation therefore reveals what the soul always was, rather than conferring anything new.

**Question, as printed:** Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (*sapta-bhaṅgī*) 'Naya'.

**Demand decoded.** The printed wording fuses two distinct doctrines - the sevenfold predication and standpoint theory. A safe answer explains **both** and expressly distinguishes them, rather than assuming the fusion is doctrinally correct.

**Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).**

The printed phrase joins two doctrines that Jaina authors keep apart, so both must be explained. Standpoint theory (*nayavāda*) concerns perspectives; the sevenfold predication (*saptabhaṅgī*) concerns propositional forms.

Standpoint theory holds that every ordinary judgement expresses a *naya*, a partial but legitimate view of a many-sided real. The classical seven are: the mixed practical or purposive standpoint (*naigama*); the generic standpoint (*saṃgraha*); the practical particular standpoint (*vyavahāra*); the present-state standpoint (*rjūsūtra*); the verbal standpoint (*śabda*); the etymological standpoint (*samabhirūḍha*); and the function-in-act standpoint (*evambhūta*), on which a person counts as a singer only while singing. The list narrows from loosest to strictest; the first three are substance-directed, the last three mode-directed and verbal, with the present-state view as the hinge.

The sevenfold predication is generated differently. Three primitives - affirmation, negation and inexpressibility - taken singly, in pairs and jointly yield exactly seven forms: *syād asti*; *syān nāsti*; *syād asti ca nāsti ca*; *syād avaktavyam*; *syād asti ca avaktavyam*; *syān nāsti ca avaktavyam*; and *syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam*. Each is governed by the operator *syāt*, which states the respect and does not mean "perhaps".

The two are related but not identical: standpoints supply the respects; predications express them in disciplined sentential form. Contradiction is avoided because opposed predications are indexed to different substance, place, time or mode. Inexpressibility marks a limit of simultaneous unqualified expression, not a third truth-value.

The doctrine is therefore a theory of conditioned assertion rather than of doubt, though critics from Śaṃkara onward hold that permanent qualification dilutes assertoric force.

PYQ 5 · 2022 · Q5(d) · 10 marks · Jainism

**Question, as printed:** How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

**Demand decoded.** Same subject-matter as 2020 Q5(a), but the directive adds "critically": the answer must end with an evaluation, not a description.

**Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).**

Because Jaina action-matter is literally material, soteriology becomes a physics of removal rather than a programme of moral improvement. Activity opens the influx channel and fixes what and how much is bound; passion fixes how long and how strongly it fruits. Hence passion-free activity produces only momentary bondage (*īryāpathika*), whereas passion-coloured activity produces durable bondage (*sāmparāyika*).

Two remedies follow, because bondage has two problems. Stoppage (*saṃvara*), operated through the vows, restraint, carefulness, the virtues, contemplations and endurance of afflictions, blocks fresh influx. Shedding (*nirjarā*), operated chiefly through austerity, exhausts what is already bound. Merit does not substitute for either, since even good karma keeps the soul in the cycle of rebirth.

Critically, the doctrine gains real explanatory precision: it grounds an ethics of intention in a causal mechanism, and it explains graded spiritual progress. Its cost is equally real. Nyāya presses that material karma cannot intelligibly bind a formless consciousness, and a Cārvāka denies the whole apparatus as unverifiable.

The account is therefore coherent within Jaina ontology, not demonstrable outside it.

**Question, as printed:** 'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.

**Demand decoded.** A stated view must be engaged, not paraphrased. Locate the equivocation, give the Jaina reply, then take a reasoned position and state what survives.

**Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).**

The quoted view rests on an equivocation between two senses of "absolute". Jaina non-absolutism (*anekāntavāda*) denies **one-sided exclusivism** by finite knowers; it does not deny that comprehensive knowledge is possible. Once the two are separated, the alleged self-contradiction dissolves.

The charge runs: the doctrine claims universal scope; universal scope appears absolute; therefore the doctrine covertly relies on what it attacks. The Jaina reply is threefold. First, the doctrine is itself asserted *syāt*, so it obeys its own rule; reflexive qualification exhibits the discipline it teaches rather than exempting itself from it. Second, the thesis is not that all judgements are equally true but that truth is aspect-conditioned, so judgements remain gradable by whether they respect their own conditions. Third, within the system omniscience (*kevala-jñāna*) is the internal case of complete knowledge, available when knowledge-obscuring karma is destroyed; ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound because ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*.

It should also be said that "relativism" mislabels the position. Jainism is ontologically realist: the aspects are objectively in the thing, and only finite access to them is partial. Relativism relativises truth; non-absolutism relativises exclusive claims.

Critically, the reply succeeds against the charge as printed but does not leave the field untouched. The unconditioned status has been relocated rather than abolished: omniscience now carries the completeness that finite discourse is denied. A critic may say this concedes the substance of the objection at a higher level.

My position is therefore qualified agreement with the Jaina: the doctrine is logically sustainable and not self-refuting, but it is not standpoint-free, and honesty requires saying that its consistency is purchased by admitting one privileged cognitive state.

**Question, as printed:** "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (*saptabhaṅgīnaya*) in the light of above statement.

**Demand decoded.** The quoted proposition is an empiricist thesis. The task is to test whether the sevenfold judgement is an instance of it, and to show precisely where Jainism agrees and where it refuses.

**Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).**

Jainism agrees with half of the statement and rejects the other half. It agrees that human knowledge is limited: ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*, partial because knowledge-obscuring karma is only partly removed, and ordinary perception is only conventionally direct.

It refuses the inference to relativism. The sevenfold judgement - the seven forms generated by affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under the operator *syāt* - records the **respects** in which a predication holds, using the indices of substance, place, time and mode. Each form is a definite assertion, not a probability estimate; *syāt* does not mean "perhaps".

Critically, the difference from empiricist relativism is ontological. For the empiricist, relativity attaches to knowledge because there is no access beyond experience. For Jainism, relativity attaches to finite judgement while the aspects remain objectively in the object, and omniscience remains internally possible.

Hence the statement describes a Jaina premise, not a Jaina conclusion: partiality of knowing does not entail relativity of truth.



**Question, as printed:** What is the distinction between Bhāvabandha and Dravyabandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.

**Demand decoded.** A single precise distinction, discussed. The answer must state both terms exactly, show their causal order, and explain why Jainism refuses to collapse them.

**Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).**

Jaina bondage has two forms which are distinct in nature yet inseparable in operation.

**Psychic bondage (bhāvabandha)** is a modification of the soul itself. Through passion, attachment, aversion, delusion and wrong disposition the soul undergoes an affective-volitional deformation. This is a state of the conscious substance, describable in the vocabulary of moral psychology.

**Material bondage (dravyabandha)** is the actual adhesion of karmic particles. Because matter alone possesses form, and because the embodied soul has space-points and is co-extensive with its body, subtle matter can be attracted and fixed. This is an event in the ontology of substances, not a description of an attitude.

The causal order is fixed: psychical action-matter (*bhāva-karma*) attracts material action-matter (*dravya-karma*). Inner deformation precedes and shapes outer adhesion. This is why the four parameters divide as they do - activity determines the type and quantity of matter bound, whereas passion, which is a psychic condition, determines duration and intensity. A monk's careful walking binds momentarily; an angry act binds deeply.

Jainism refuses to collapse the pair because each carries something the other cannot. Retain only psychic bondage and karma becomes a metaphor, leaving the obscuration of an intrinsically omniscient soul unexplained. Retain only material bondage and the system becomes crude physicalism in which intention is irrelevant to moral consequence.

The distinction also organises the path: stoppage works primarily on the psychic side by removing the causes of influx, while shedding works on the material deposit already formed.

Critically, the pairing preserves both agency and ontology, though the interaction of a formless soul with subtle matter - the very point Nyāya attacks - remains the doctrine's unresolved joint.

**Question, as printed:** Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

**Demand decoded.** Two labels, both to be tested. "Critically" requires that each be affirmed with the correct qualifier rather than simply endorsed.

**Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).**

Jaina philosophy is strongly pluralistic and realistic, but its realism must be described as qualified.

It is pluralistic in three independent ways. Ontologically it admits six substances - soul, matter, medium of motion, medium of rest, space and time - of which five are extended. Psychologically it admits innumerable souls, each beginningless and numerically distinct. Soteriologically it holds that liberation produces many perfected souls at the summit of the world, with no merger into any absolute. Monistic reduction is refused at every level.

It is realistic in that substances, qualities and modes are objectively real; the external world is not appearance; and knowledge aims at real objects. Aspects are in the thing, not projected onto it, which is why many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*) is an ontological thesis before it is a logical one.

The qualifier is epistemic. Because finite cognition is *kṣāyopāśamika* and therefore partial, judgement is standpoint-indexed and assertion carries the operator *syāt*. This yields the decisive formula: qualification of **knowledge** does not entail unreality of the **object**. Ontological realism and epistemic non-absolutism are separable, and Jainism holds both.

Critically, two costs deserve statement. First, Rāmānuja objects that a real substance bearing opposed real attributes is unintelligible, and a Dharmakīrti-style Buddhist presses that a permanent-yet-changing soul fails the test of causal efficacy; the Jaina reply, that the opposition is between aspects of substance and mode, persuades only those who already grant aspect-realism. Second, the pluralism is metaphysically expensive, requiring material action-matter and



intrinsically omniscient souls that a Cārvāka will reject as unverifiable.

The defensible verdict is therefore that Jainism is genuinely pluralistic and genuinely realistic, but its realism is qualified realism rather than naive realism.

#### PYQ 10 · 2020 · Q7(c) · 15 marks · Cārvāka (supporting routed question)

**Question, as printed:** Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism. **Routing note:** primary ownership rests with Cārvāka; it is solved here because the Jaina half of the contrast is owned by this topic and is the half most often written badly.

**Demand decoded.** "Explain the differences" is comparative and expository. Use fixed axes so that the contrast is systematic rather than anecdotal.

**Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).**

Cārvāka and Jainism differ on the definition of the real, on its inventory and on the reach of knowledge.

**Definition.** Cārvāka recognises as real only what is materially constituted and, in principle, perceptible. Jainism defines the real as that which possesses origination, decay and persistence together, so permanence and change are equally real in one thing, indexed to substance and mode.

**Inventory.** Cārvāka admits four elements - earth, water, fire and air - and characteristically rejects ether. Jainism admits six substances, five of them extended, including a conscious substance and two cosmological media that Cārvāka has no use for. Where Cārvāka has one kind of stuff, Jainism has an irreducibly plural ontology.

**Consciousness.** For Cārvāka, awareness emerges from the organised body, so the living body qualified by consciousness is the self. For Jainism, consciousness is the defining quality of an independent soul, and there are innumerable such souls, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge that karma obscures.

**Moral consequence and liberation.** Cārvāka rejects action-consequence, rebirth and liberation. Jainism makes action-matter literally material, so bondage is a real deposit and liberation is its removal.

**Knowledge.** Cārvāka restricts valid knowledge to perception and refuses inference independent standing. Jainism accepts inference and testimony as indirect, treats ordinary perception as only conventionally direct, and grades knowledge up to omniscience.

The deepest difference is methodological. Cārvāka's ontology contracts to fit one means of knowledge; Jainism's theory of knowledge expands to fit a many-sided reality. One shrinks the world to secure certainty; the other qualifies assertion to preserve the world's complexity.

#### ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE - SIX MODELS

These six questions are original practice items written in UPSC style. They are not previous-year questions and are not represented as such.

#### Original 1 · 10 marks

**Question:** Distinguish between many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*), standpoint theory (*nayavāda*) and conditional predication (*syādvāda*). Why is the order of derivation philosophically significant?

**Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).**

The three doctrines occupy different levels and are derived in a fixed order.

Many-sidedness is **metaphysical**: the real object is *ananta-dharmātmakam vastu*, constituted by innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it. Standpoint theory is **epistemic**: because finite cognition is partial, every ordinary judgement expresses a *naya*, one legitimate perspective among many; a standpoint that denies the rest becomes its perversion. Conditional predication is **logical-linguistic**: assertion must carry *syāt*, stating the respect in which it holds, and the sevenfold predication is its formal schema.

The order matters for two reasons. First, it makes the logic non-arbitrary. If many-sidedness came last, the *syāt* operator would look like a debating trick; derived first, it makes qualification obligatory. Second, it protects realism. The aspects are in the object; only access is partial. Reversing the order would make Jainism a theory about language

or attitude rather than about the world.

Hence a script that names the three terms but not their levels has recited without explaining.

### Original 2 · 10 marks

**Question:** "In Jainism the moral quality of an act is fixed by passion rather than by activity." Examine this claim with reference to the parameters of bondage.

#### Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

The claim is accurate if stated with care. Karmic bondage is analysed under four parameters. Activity of body, speech and mind determines the **type** (*prakṛti*) of karma bound and the **quantity** (*pradeśa*) of matter bound. Passion determines the **duration** (*sthiti*) and the **intensity** (*anubhāga*) of its fruition.

Since duration and intensity are the parameters that actually decide how heavily an act weighs on the future of the soul, the moral seriousness of an act tracks passion rather than mere movement. The doctrinal expression of this is the contrast between momentary bondage from passion-free activity and durable bondage from passion-coloured activity: a monk's careful walking binds only momentarily, while an angry act binds deeply.

The claim must nevertheless be qualified. Activity is not morally irrelevant, since it fixes what is bound at all, and total cessation of activity belongs only to the fourteenth stage.

The precise formulation is therefore that activity determines the karmic content while passion determines its karmic weight.

### Original 3 · 15 marks

**Question:** Examine the Jaina claim that ordinary sense-perception is only conventionally direct. What does this reveal about the relation between Jaina epistemology and Jaina soteriology?

#### Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Jainism divides valid knowledge into direct (*pratyakṣa*) and indirect (*parokṣa*), but measures directness by absence of mediation rather than by sensory vividness. Ordinary sense-perception depends on sense-organs, the mind, signs and karmic limitation. It is therefore only **conventional direct knowledge** (*sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa*) and strictly belongs with mediated cognition. What is direct in the full sense is knowledge the soul has by itself: limited clairvoyance (*avadhi*), knowledge of others' mental modes (*manaḥparyāya*) and omniscience (*kevala*).

The claim is defensible on its own terms. It preserves ordinary life, since perception remains valid for practical dealings; it distinguishes practical adequacy from metaphysical finality; and it avoids the Nyāya assumption that sense-contact is the paradigm of directness.

What it reveals is that Jaina epistemology is not a free-standing theory. The five kinds of knowledge are stations on a single curve of karmic unveiling: *matī* and *śruta* are mediated, the remaining three progressively direct, and omniscience is the state in which knowledge-obscuring karma has been destroyed. Knowledge is therefore graded by **purity**, not by method.

Two consequences follow. First, conditional predication becomes obligatory rather than optional, because a *kṣāyopaśamika* knower cannot make an unconditioned claim. Second, wrong cognition is orientation-relative: *kumati*, *kuśruta* and *vibhaṅga* are cognitions held under wrong vision, so error is a spiritual as well as a logical category.

Critically, this integration is the system's strength and its exposure. It gives Jainism a unified account of knowing and liberation, but it makes the epistemology depend on an ontology of soul and karmic matter that an empiricist critic will refuse at the outset.

### Original 4 · 15 marks

**Question:** "Jaina non-violence is a metaphysical consequence, not a sentiment." Critically discuss with reference to the doctrine of the soul and the mechanics of bondage.

#### Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The claim is well founded. Jaina non-violence (*ahiṃsā*) is derived, not asserted.

The derivation begins in ontology. Souls are innumerable and graded from one-sense immobile beings - earth-, water-, fire-, air- and plant-bodied - to five-sense mobile beings. Every one of them is a conscious substance intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad and currently obscured. Injury therefore falls on a knower, not on a thing.

It continues in the mechanics of bondage. Injury is characteristically produced by passion, and passion fixes the duration and intensity of karmic adhesion. Violence is thus not merely wrong by a rule; it is causally the most efficient way to deepen bondage. Non-violence, conversely, is an operation of stoppage: it closes the channel through which the heaviest karma enters.

The doctrine is graded rather than utopian. Ascetics take the great vows; householders take the lesser vows; and carefulness in movement, speech, alms-seeking, handling objects and bodily functions extends the principle into ordinary conduct. Extreme care toward one-sense beings is an implication of the ontology, not an excess of feeling.

Critically, two points deserve statement. First, the derivation is only as strong as its premises: a critic who denies that plants or elemental bodies house souls will accept the ethics while rejecting its scope. Second, the account is intention-sensitive rather than consequence-sensitive, which is a philosophical choice with costs of its own.

Nevertheless, the central contention holds: Jaina non-violence follows from plural souls and karmic mechanics, and treating it as sentiment removes precisely the argument that makes it distinctive among Indian ethical positions.

### Original 5 · 20 marks

**Question:** Analyse the Jaina fourteen stages of spiritual development. How do the two ladders explain spiritual relapse, and what does this show about the relation between insight and conduct in Jainism?

#### Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The fourteen stages (*guṇasthāna*) map the soul's movement from false vision to final liberation, and they are graded by karmic condition rather than by external observance.

Stages one to three describe wrong, falling and mixed orientation. Stage four, right vision without restraint, is the decisive breakthrough: right vision (*samyag-darśana*) becomes stable enough to orient the path even though conduct has not yet followed. Stage five introduces partial restraint through lay vows. Stages six and seven mark full restraint with and then without negligence. Stages eight to ten describe progressive purification of the passions, from unprecedented purification through advanced purification to the condition in which only subtle greed remains. Stages eleven and twelve mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion. Stage thirteen is the embodied omniscient being, and stage fourteen the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state.

The two ladders explain relapse without treating it as mere failure. On the ladder of suppression (*upaśama-śreṇi*), delusion is covered rather than removed; such a soul may reach the eleventh stage, but because suppressed delusion retains its potency the fall is necessary, not accidental. On the ladder of annihilation (*kṣapaka-śreṇi*), delusion is destroyed, so the twelfth stage is stable and the ascent continues to omniscience.

Three philosophical consequences follow. First, appearance and condition come apart: two souls may look identical at the tenth stage and have opposite futures, which is why Jainism refuses to identify spiritual attainment with observable conduct alone. Second, insight and conduct are interdependent rather than alternative. Right vision at stage four is genuine yet insufficient; conduct without right vision has no orientation; and the ladder records the joint operation of the three jewels. Third, omniscience is decoupled from disembodiment: destroying the destructive karmas yields omniscience at stage thirteen, while the non-destructive karmas sustain body, status, lifespan and felt experience until the end.

Critically, an Advaita-style objection holds that a fourteen-stage ladder mechanises liberation, substituting a karmic audit for insight. The Jaina reply is that insight which does not destroy karma has not yet done its work, and that the ladder simply records the difference between a covered and a destroyed defilement.

The scheme is therefore best evaluated as a psychology of purification with an unusually honest account of relapse, and its taxonomic weight is the price of that honesty.

Original 6 · 20 marks

**Question:** "Jainism preserves the reality of the world at the cost of the simplicity of logic; Advaita preserves the simplicity of logic at the cost of the reality of the world." Critically examine this comparison.

**Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).**

The comparison is illuminating but requires correction on both sides.

On the Jaina side it is broadly accurate. Jainism refuses to treat either permanence or change as appearance. The real is defined as originating, decaying and persisting together, so both are secured - but the price is that predication must be indexed. Assertion carries the operator *syāt*; opposed predications are separated by substance, place, time and mode; and the exhaustive schema of qualified assertion contains seven forms rather than a simple affirmation and denial. Ontological economy is sacrificed too: six substances, innumerable souls and material action-matter are admitted because each performs explanatory work. The world is saved, and logic becomes intricate.

On the Advaita side the statement needs care. Advaita does not abandon the world; it grades it. The world is empirically real and only ultimately *mithyā*, and sublation, not denial, is the operative notion. What Advaita gains is a single ultimate reality with a straightforward account of contradiction: opposed characterisations belong to different levels, and the lower is finally cancelled. So the accurate formulation is that Advaita preserves logical simplicity by admitting **levels of reality**, whereas Jainism preserves ontological plurality by admitting **respects of predication**.

That reformulation locates the real difference. Both schools face the problem of apparently opposed predicates. Advaita separates them **vertically**, by rank, with the lower cancelled at realisation. Jainism separates them **horizontally**, by aspect, with nothing cancelled at all. Vertical separation buys a simple logic and requires a doctrine of appearance; horizontal separation buys an unqualified realism and requires a doctrine of conditional assertion.

Critically, each pays where the other saves. Śaṃkara charges that Jaina qualification erodes assertoric force and that a doctrine which qualifies even itself cannot claim universal scope. The Jaina replies that reflexive qualification is obedience rather than exemption, and counter-charges that treating the world as ultimately *mithyā* purchases simplicity by demoting the very reality it set out to explain. Neither charge is answerable from a neutral standpoint, because each presupposes what the other denies.

The defensible verdict is that the quoted comparison identifies a genuine trade-off but mislabels the Advaita side. Jainism trades logical simplicity for unqualified realism; Advaita trades ontological plurality, not the world itself, for a single unsublated real.